

Food Swaps for Getting RIPPED

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 10, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/-jMs2lDvYcM> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter walks through four quick supermarket swaps to cut calories while still eating satisfying food — ideal for anyone in a cutting phase trying to stay lean without giving up meat.

Contents

-  Swap 1: Chicken Tenders → Rotisserie Chicken
-  Swap 2: Ribeye Steak → Sirloin Steak
-  Swap 3: Bacon → Turkey Bacon
-  Swap 4: Chicken Thighs → Chicken Breast
-  Swap 5: Avocado → Leafy Greens

Swap 1: Chicken Tenders → Rotisserie Chicken 0:00

- The problem with chicken tenders is the preparation — breading and frying adds unwanted calories during a cut
- **Solution:** grab a pre-cooked rotisserie chicken from the meat aisle
 - Already cooked, so zero extra effort required
 - Eat it as-is — no cooking needed
- Bonus tip to cut calories even further: skip the skin
 - The skin is where a significant portion of the fat (and therefore calories) sits

Swap 2: Ribeye Steak → Sirloin Steak 0:22

- Ribeye is described as "delicious" but carries far more calories than is practical when cutting
 - High fat marbling is what makes ribeye flavorful — and calorie-dense
- **Solution:** sirloin steak, found right next to the ribeye in the meat aisle
 - Sirloin is "way leaner" with "way less calories"
 - You still get steak for dinner — satisfaction is preserved
 - Easier to fit within a caloric deficit

Swap 3: Bacon → Turkey Bacon 0:22

- Regular bacon is high in calories due to its fat content
- **Solution:** turkey bacon
 - Brandon candidly admits it "is not as good" in taste
 - However, it is significantly lower in calories, making it a practical swap during a cut

Swap 4: Chicken Thighs → Chicken Breast 0:44

- Chicken thighs are called "the most delicious part of the chicken" but contain notably more calories than chicken breast
- **Solution:** chicken breast
 - Brandon is unusually blunt: "I hate chicken breasts with my whole heart. I think they're gross."
 - Despite his personal distaste, he acknowledges that when cutting, chicken breast is the right call

"I hate chicken breasts with my whole heart. I think they're gross. But, if I'm cutting, I might end up eating them."

Swap 5: Avocado → Leafy Greens 0:44

- Avocados are acknowledged as "delicious and nutritious" — not a bad food in general
 - The issue is caloric density: avocados pack a lot of calories into a small volume
 - When cutting, calorically dense foods make it harder to stay in a deficit
- **Solution:** swap avocado for leafy greens
 - Greens allow you to eat a large volume of food and feel full
 - They are not calorically dense, so you get satiety without blowing your calorie budget